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Netflix pushes HDR

The iPhone 8, iPhone X and 2017 iPad Pro will receive HDR support for Netflix.
<http://digit.in/iOSHDR>

**Terminator: Genisys ignored**

Terminator star Arnold has confirmed that Terminator 6 will completely ignore Terminator: Genisys. <http://digit.in/Tmnr6>

ASUS GX501 Zephyrus Gaming Laptop with NVIDIA Max-Q

Slim and power-packed

A SUS's GX501 or Zephyrus has been enjoying quite a bit of attention thanks to it being the first gaming laptop to feature NVIDIA's Max-Q technology. Naturally, we were a bit curious to have a look at how a Max-Q laptop is designed.

Build

The Zephyrus has a very minimalist approach. The top half of the clam has a brushed metal finish with a sharp line where it appears as if two halves meet just like the confluence of two streams. The ASUS GX501 Zephyrus is powered by the Intel Core i7-7700HQ and an NVIDIA GTX 1080 (Max-Q). So we're expecting quite a lot from the unit, what stands to be seen is where the laptop throttles, if at all it does, and how much do we end up losing out on gaming performance.

Despite the thinness of the laptop, ASUS has managed to squeeze in a 50 Whr battery which is commendable feat, however, with a GTX 1080 that's set to be drained quickly. The other noteworthy addition is that of a 230 W power adapter.

There's hardly any elevation in the centre of the laptop. It's very thin coming in at 17.9 mm.

The underside is very different from all the laptops we've seen for a really long time. Why? The absence of vents, that's why. There are two lean vents on either side but they seem ridiculously ill-prepared to handle an NVIDIA GTX 1080. It's only when you open the lid, that you see vents magically appear out of nowhere. Since the Zephyrus makes use of the fancy hatch system, the rear of the



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laptop gets a little elevated upon being completely open. At this point, the display is at an angle of 120 degrees from the base. Compared to some of the previously tested units, this seems a bit low if you were to keep the Zephyrus on your lap.

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Since the ASUS ROG GX501 is thicker than most convertibles, they've added USB Type-A ports on both sides. All of them being USB 3.1 except the Type-C port which is 3.2. There's an HDMI port included. The only obvious ports that aren't present are the Ethernet port and a card reader.

Performance

We started with Cinebench for the Zephyrus and managed to get 160 points and 1.82 points in R15 and R11.5 single-thread benchmarks, respectively. As for multi-threaded runs, the GX501 scored 735 and 8.14 points in

R15 and R11.5. Running CrystalDiskMark on the NVMe SSD resulted in 3450 MB/s for QD32 sequential read and 1828 MB/s for QD32 sequential write speeds. Moving onto gaming, we managed to get 18211 points in 3DMark Fire Strike graphics test. Games ran at 4K with absolute ease, Doom did 54 FPS on 4K while on 1080p Ultra it scored 126 FPS. That's pretty damn good for a Max-Q graphics card which claims

to have been designed for power efficient use cases. Generally, that spells trouble for any component but we'd say, we're pleasantly surprised. Rise of the Tomb Raider scored 105 FPS on Ultra and PUBG scored 77 FPS with all settings completely set to the maximum possible values. The Intel Core i7-7700HQ is quite powerful in its own right, but the Max-Q GTX 1080 isn't a far cry from its normal beefier form either.

Verdict

The ASUS ROG GX501 Zephyrus bridges the gap between performance and portability. At Digit, we simply can't count the number of times that we've been asked for recommendations that could not only provide great portability but also not compromise on performance. Often, the answer was an either-or but never could you have an option with both. The ROG GX501 is an exception to that rule.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7 7700HQ | PLATFORM: HM175 | RAM: 24 GB 2400 MHz | SCREEN SIZE: 15.6-inches | SCREEN RESOLUTION: 1920x1080 | GPU: GTX 1080 8 GB GDDR5X | SSD: Samsung SM961 1 TB NVMe | BATTERY: 50 Whr | AC ADAPTER: 230 W | WEIGHT: 2.25 kg

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